

Aster Legal - Legal Hold Administration Guide

Matter Alpha AL-PA-2606 | Operating baseline as of 2026-06-30

Purpose. This synthetic guide defines the administration rhythm for the Matter Alpha legal hold. It is an internal training artifact and contains no real legal matter, personal data, or privileged material.

1. Matter baseline

The active hold population is 42 custodians. As of 2026-06-30, 38 custodians have acknowledged the notice and four remain pending. The source register identifies 53 sources: 48 are preservation-ready and five require managed exceptions.

Role	Accountability	Cadence
Privacy Counsel	Owns hold decision, scope changes, and suspension authorization	At issuance and on material change
Legal Operations	Tracks acknowledgements, source readiness, and exception evidence	Weekly until stable
IT Preservation Liaison	Confirms technical preservation controls and access constraints	Weekly / on exception
Custodian Manager	Escalates overdue responses without accessing content	At day 2 and day 5

2. Administration procedure

- Issue and log the notice using the Matter Alpha identifier. Record issued date, custodian ID, role, delivery channel, and acknowledgement date; use synthetic role identifiers in training examples.
- Review acknowledgement status twice weekly. Escalate the four pending acknowledgements through their manager and record outreach without copying protected content into the tracker.
- Maintain the source register with source category, preservation state, owner, technical control, and exception reference. Confirm that the 48 ready sources remain protected after any relevant system change.
- Report a concise status to Privacy Counsel: hold population, acknowledgement count, source readiness, open exceptions, blockers, and next review date.

3. Exception workflow

For each of the five exception sources, Legal Operations opens a dated exception entry, assigns an accountable owner, records the preservation risk, and sets a remediation or disposition target. The owner supplies a factual status; Privacy Counsel records the decision basis. Closure for this initial set was approved on 2026-07-12, while the underlying hold remains active.

Exception closure checklist: (1) source identity is specific; (2) technical condition is documented; (3) preservation alternative or reasoned disposition is recorded; (4) owner attestation is captured; (5) Privacy Counsel approves closure; and (6) the register retains an audit trail.

4. Change control and suspension

A change to custodians, sources, or preservation instructions requires a dated update from Privacy Counsel. Legal Operations issues revised notice text only after the change is logged. A source becoming newly available after exception closure must be preserved and added to the register promptly.

No custodian is released by an informal message or tracker status. A preservation suspension must be written, authorized by Privacy Counsel, linked to Matter Alpha AL-PA-2606, and distributed to affected custodians. The separate suspension notice in this folder is a synthetic template and is not effective.

5. Quality controls

Before each weekly review, reconcile the 42-person population to acknowledgement records; reconcile 53 sources to readiness and exception entries; identify variance from the 38 acknowledged / 4 pending and 48 ready / 5 exception baselines; and retain only necessary workflow metadata. Do not include real names, content, credentials, or actual legal advice in training records.

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